DSCT

D01–D10 Unified Framework · 2026-04-07

OVERALL SCORE	MATURITY	FRAMEWORK
46%	Foundational	ISO 31031:2022 D01–D10 Unified 2026-04-07

DIMENSION SCORES

D01	D02	D03	D04	D05
Governance & Policy	Risk Assessment	Partner Vetting	Pre-Departure Documentation	Staffing & Ratios
52%	44%	30%	48%	58%

D06	D07	D08	D09	D10
Medical & Welfare	Safeguarding	Incident Response	Communications	Post-Trip Review
45%	28%	63%	56%	38%

KEY FINDINGS

Strength	Strong safety culture and operational non-negotiables: DSCT's five non-negotiables (headcount, no student alone, helmet always, van in contact, ride stops for injury) are...
Strength	Radical transparency about known gaps: Section 8 (Gaps Table) and the prefatory 'living document' framing demonstrate an unusual level of honest self-assessment for a v1.0...
Critical Gap	No safeguarding or child protection policy identified in submitted materials: For a provider operating with school-age students across 8 international destinations, the absence of...
Critical Gap	No partner or supplier vetting framework identified in submitted materials: DSCT's operations depend on accommodation providers, bike rental partners, and local operators across...
Critical Gap	No formal risk assessment process or pre-trip destination risk analysis identified in submitted materials: While the go/no-go framework in Section 4 demonstrates practical risk...
High Priority	No medical information collection or pre-departure documentation package identified in submitted materials: DSCT has not yet developed participant medical disclosure forms,...
High Priority	Post-trip review and learning capture is aspirational rather than operational: The living document philosophy is genuinely commendable, but no formal post-trip debrief process,...

HOW TO READ THIS DOCUMENT

Dimensions are classified as Leading (90%+), Established (70–89%), Developing (50–69%), or Foundational (0–49%). Critical and high-priority gaps represent constraints for school deployment. The priority action plan that follows provides advisory timelines.

DSCT

Dimension D01 · Governance & Policy

D01 Governance & Policy

ISO 31031:2022 §7.2, §7.4

52% Developing

MATURITY BAND

Foundational	Developing	Established	Leading
0–49%	50–69%	70–89%	90%+

CONTEXT SUMMARY

DSCT's Operations & Safety Manual (DSCT-OPS-001 v1.0) demonstrates a genuine leadership philosophy and a clear commitment to safety through its transparent, self-aware framing. The founder's voice is present throughout, and the document acknowledges its own developmental status explicitly. However, as a formal governance instrument, it falls short of the structured policy framework typically expected under ISO 31031:2022 §7.2 and §7.4.

EVIDENCE IDENTIFIED

Evidence from Submitted Materials

DSCT-OPS-001 v1.0, Cover Page: 'Dan Skimin Cycling Tours operates on the radical premise that if you hire good people, give them good bikes, send them to beautiful places, and treat students like the intelligent humans they are — most things work out just fine.' — Establishes founder-led philosophy and intent.

DSCT-OPS-001 v1.0, Page 2 (Prefatory Note): 'Version 1.0 means we wrote down what we know now. Version 1.1 will have the things we learn on the first few tours.' — Demonstrates a living document governance model with explicit version control intent.

DSCT-OPS-001 v1.0, Page 2: 'The Non-Negotiables — There are five things in this document that are not suggestions. They are marked with this symbol: ▯.' — Establishes a tiered policy structure distinguishing non-negotiables from guidance.

DSCT-OPS-001 v1.0, Appendix (Page 8): 'Dan Skimin — Director, Date of Issue: March 2026' — Confirms named accountable leader and issue date, providing basic document authority.

DSCT-OPS-001 v1.0, Page 2 (Role Table): Defines four roles (Ride Leader, Support Driver, School Trip Leader, Dan Skimin) with responsibilities and document engagement expectations — partial accountability framework present.

GAPS IDENTIFIED

– No formal travel risk management policy statement identified in submitted materials — a document articulating organisational scope, objectives, and risk appetite as distinct from operational guidance.

– No evidence of governance structure beyond the founder — no board, committee, or oversight body identified in submitted materials.

– No documented review cycle or policy renewal schedule identified in submitted materials beyond the general 'living document' aspiration.

– No alignment statement to any external standard (e.g. ISO 31031, ATOL, DfE guidance) identified in submitted materials.

– No formal document control register or version history log identified in submitted materials — version notes are invited but no entries exist in v1.0.

Recommendation

Consider developing a brief (1–2 page) formal policy statement that articulates DSCT's risk management scope, objectives, and risk appetite separately from the operational manual. A common approach is to have the operational document sit beneath a governing policy that provides the 'why' and 'what', while the manual covers the 'how'. Adding a documented annual review trigger and a named deputy for governance continuity would materially strengthen this dimension.

0	5	+18%
FINDINGS ON THIS DIMENSION	GAPS IDENTIFIED	TO ESTABLISHED

DSCT

Dimension D02 · Risk Assessment

D02 Risk Assessment

ISO 31031:2022 §8.4

44% Foundational

MATURITY BAND

Foundational	Developing	Established	Leading
0–49%	50–69%	70–89%	90%+

CONTEXT SUMMARY

DSCT's manual contains meaningful operational risk guidance — particularly around weather, heat, road conditions, and in-ride hazards — that reflects genuine field experience and practical risk thinking. The go/no-go decision framework in Section 4 is particularly strong for an operational document. However, no formal risk assessment process is identified in the submitted materials.

EVIDENCE IDENTIFIED

Evidence from Submitted Materials

DSCT-OPS-001 v1.0, Section 4 (Page 5): Go/No-Go decision table with five condition categories (Rain, Wind, Heat, Participant condition, Road conditions) each with three response levels (Ride as Planned, Modify the Route, No Ride Today) — structured operational risk decision framework.

DSCT-OPS-001 v1.0, Section 4 (Page 5): 'Heat exhaustion signs: heavy sweating, pale skin, nausea, weakness... Heat stroke: confusion, no sweating, hot red skin. Medical emergency.' — Demonstrates hazard identification and response linkage for health risks.

DSCT-OPS-001 v1.0, Section 3 (Page 4): 'Wet cobblestones (T1 Loire, T7 Slovenia Ljubljana) are genuinely treacherous. Walk the bike if the surface is suspect.' — Tour-specific hazard identification present in limited form.

DSCT-OPS-001 v1.0, Section 4 (Page 5): 'The Conservative Decision Is Always Right. Nobody ever complained that the Ride Leader was too careful.' — Risk appetite statement embedded in operational guidance.

DSCT-OPS-001 v1.0, Section 8 (Page 7, Gaps Table): 'Tour-specific emergency contacts — Local hospitals, police, embassy contacts per tour — Pre-departure research for each tour' — Acknowledges gap in destination-specific risk intelligence.

GAPS IDENTIFIED

– No formal pre-trip risk assessment document or template identified in submitted materials for any of the 8 listed tour destinations.

– No risk register or structured risk log identified in submitted materials — risks are described narratively rather than catalogued and evaluated.

– No likelihood or consequence scoring methodology identified in submitted materials — the go/no-go table provides operational triggers but not a transferable risk evaluation framework.

– No evidence of destination-level political, security, or travel advisory assessment (e.g. FCDO/State Department integration) identified in submitted materials.

– No documented process for route-specific risk assessment prior to each tour identified in submitted materials.

– Tour-specific risk data explicitly noted as incomplete: 'Add them here as we learn them' (Section 4, Page 5) — confirms absence of destination risk profiles for all 8 tours at v1.0.

Recommendation

Consider developing a pre-trip risk assessment template that covers destination risk (political, health, environmental), route-specific hazards, and participant profile factors. A common approach is a simple two-page risk register per tour destination that is completed and reviewed before each departure. Integrating FCDO or equivalent travel advisory checks into a documented pre-departure process would address the destination intelligence gap. The existing go/no-go table is a strong foundation — consider formalising it as part of a broader risk assessment toolkit.

1	6	+6%
FINDINGS ON THIS DIMENSION	GAPS IDENTIFIED	TO DEVELOPING

D03 Partner Vetting

ISO 31031:2022 §8.5, Annex A.4

30% Foundational

MATURITY BAND

Foundational	Developing	Established	Leading
0–49%	50–69%	70–89%	90%+

CONTEXT SUMMARY

No evidence of a partner or supplier vetting framework is identified in the submitted materials. DSCT operates tours across 8 international destinations involving accommodation providers, bike rental partners, and local operators. The manual references bike rental partners once (Section 8, Gaps Table) in the context of maintenance responsibilities, and accommodation is listed as a known gap.

EVIDENCE IDENTIFIED

Evidence from Submitted Materials

DSCT-OPS-001 v1.0, Section 8 (Page 7, Gaps Table): 'Bike maintenance on tour — What a Ride Leader can fix, what the van carries, what gets escalated — Collaborate with bike rental partners per tour' — Acknowledges existence of bike rental partners but no vetting framework described.

DSCT-OPS-001 v1.0, Section 8 (Page 7, Gaps Table): 'Accommodation security standards — Minimum standards for student room security — First season learnings' — Explicitly identifies accommodation standards as a known gap with no current criteria.

DSCT-OPS-001 v1.0, Section 1 (Page 3): Support Driver role described as carrying 'the luggage, the first aid kit, the spare bikes, the extra water' — implies supply chain exists but no vetting or qualification criteria referenced.

GAPS IDENTIFIED

– No supplier/partner vetting process or criteria identified in submitted materials for any category of third-party provider (accommodation, bike rental, local guides, transport).

– No accommodation minimum standards document identified in submitted materials — explicitly acknowledged as a gap in Section 8.

– No evidence of insurance verification requirements for third-party suppliers identified in submitted materials.

– No contractual or service agreement framework with local partners identified in submitted materials.

– No process for ongoing monitoring or annual review of partner performance identified in submitted materials.

– No evidence of local operator competence assessment for any of the 8 tour destinations identified in submitted materials.

Recommendation

Consider developing a supplier approval checklist that covers minimum insurance requirements, safety certifications, accommodation security standards, and bike maintenance standards for rental partners. A common approach is a tiered supplier register — distinguishing between critical suppliers (accommodation, bikes) and ancillary suppliers — with documented approval criteria and annual review triggers. Given that this is a student-facing operation, accommodation security standards in particular would typically be a prerequisite for school engagement.

1	6	+20%
FINDINGS ON THIS DIMENSION	GAPS IDENTIFIED	TO DEVELOPING

D04 Pre-Departure Documentation

ISO 31031:2022 §A.1, §8.2

48% Foundational

MATURITY BAND

Foundational	Developing	Established	Leading
0–49%	50–69%	70–89%	90%+

CONTEXT SUMMARY

The submitted materials contain meaningful pre-departure elements — role responsibilities, document distribution expectations, and Day 1 briefing content — but no formal pre-departure documentation package is identified. There is evidence that students are informed of daily plans, regroup points, and emergency contacts, which reflects good operational practice. However, no participant information pack, consent form framework, medical disclosure process, or pre-departure communication template is identified in the submitted materials.

EVIDENCE IDENTIFIED

Evidence from Submitted Materials

DSCT-OPS-001 v1.0, Section 1 (Page 3): 'School Trip Leader — Non-negotiables: First Aid certified. Knows the route. Has read this document. Has a functioning phone and the support driver's number memorised.' — Pre-departure knowledge requirements for school representative documented.

DSCT-OPS-001 v1.0, Section 1 (Page 3): 'Students are treated as capable people... They know the day's plan, the lunch stop, the hotel, and what to do if something goes wrong.' — Intent to brief students pre-departure on operational information.

DSCT-OPS-001 v1.0, Section 6 (Page 7): 'TO BUILD — A one-page communication plan template for each school partner — who to call, when, and what to say. We'll build this with the first 2–3 school partners and standardise from there.' — Explicitly flags pre-departure communication planning as absent.

DSCT-OPS-001 v1.0, Section 2 (Page 3): 'ADD HERE LATER — We'll add a standard morning briefing script here once we've run a few tours.' — Day 1 briefing structure not yet formalised.

DSCT-OPS-001 v1.0, Section 3 (Page 4): 'Ride Leader confirms local road rules on Day 1 of each tour.' — Confirms Day 1 safety briefing element present.

DSCT-OPS-001 v1.0, Back Card: Lists emergency contacts structure (Dan Skimin, Support Driver, School Trip Leader, Local Emergency, International Emergency 112) — basic emergency reference card exists.

GAPS IDENTIFIED

– No participant information pack or pre-departure briefing document identified in submitted materials for student or parent distribution.

– No medical disclosure or health information collection form identified in submitted materials.

– No consent or permissions framework for participants identified in submitted materials.

– No pre-departure communication plan template identified in submitted materials — explicitly flagged as 'TO BUILD' in Section 6.

– No kit list, travel readiness checklist, or fitness preparation guidance identified in submitted materials for participants.

– No tour-specific pre-departure information (destination overview, cultural guidance, packing list) identified in submitted materials for any of the 8 tours.

– Morning briefing script explicitly noted as not yet developed (Section 2, Page 3).

Recommendation

Consider developing a pre-departure information pack as a priority — this would typically include a participant welcome letter, kit list, medical disclosure form, emergency contact collection, and destination overview. A common approach is to structure this as a school-facing pack (shared with the trip leader 6–8 weeks before departure) and a student-facing pack (shared 2 weeks before). The communication plan template flagged in Section 6 is a logical starting point. Medical information collection in particular is a prerequisite for safe operation with student groups.

D05 Staffing & Ratios

ISO 31031:2022 §7.5

58% Developing

MATURITY BAND

Foundational	Developing	Established	Leading
0–49%	50–69%	70–89%	90%+

CONTEXT SUMMARY

DSCT's manual provides a reasonably clear description of staffing roles and their responsibilities, and articulates meaningful competence requirements for the Ride Leader position. The non-negotiable that 'no student rides alone' and the paired buddy system demonstrate awareness of supervision requirements. However, no numerical staff-to-student ratios are specified, no formal staff qualification or recruitment criteria beyond a First Aid at Work certificate are documented, and no training programme or ongoing competence assessment framework is identified in the submitted materials.

EVIDENCE IDENTIFIED

Evidence from Submitted Materials

DSCT-OPS-001 v1.0, Section 5 (Page 6): 'Minimum standard: current First Aid at Work certificate required for all Ride Leaders.' — Formal competence requirement stated for lead role.

DSCT-OPS-001 v1.0, Section 1 (Page 3): Ride Leader, Support Driver, and School Trip Leader roles each described with specific responsibilities and boundaries of authority — clear role definition present.

DSCT-OPS-001 v1.0, Section 1 (Page 3): 'Defers to the Ride Leader on all cycling safety and route decisions — this is the agreed division of authority.' — Division of responsibility between DSCT and school staff formally stated.

DSCT-OPS-001 v1.0, Section 3 (Page 4): 1 No student rides alone. Minimum buddy pair at all times. If a student drops off the back, the rider behind them stays with them until they're back with the group or in the support van.' — Supervision non-negotiable documented.

DSCT-OPS-001 v1.0, Appendix (Page 8): Staff sign-off sheet requiring named Ride Leaders and Support Drivers to confirm they have read and understood the document — basic onboarding confirmation process present.

DSCT-OPS-001 v1.0, Section 3 (Page 4): 'Ride Leader at front OR drop to the back to monitor the group — never in the middle where they can't see both ends.' — Operational supervision standard for cycling described.

GAPS IDENTIFIED

– No staff-to-student ratio specified in submitted materials for any tour size or configuration.

– No Ride Leader recruitment criteria or job specification identified in submitted materials beyond the First Aid at Work certificate requirement.

– No staff training programme, induction structure, or pre-tour briefing framework for DSCT staff identified in submitted materials.

– No ongoing competence assessment or annual performance review process for Ride Leaders identified in submitted materials.

– No minimum cycling competence or guide qualification standard for Ride Leaders identified in submitted materials.

– No DBS check, background screening, or equivalent child safety vetting requirement for DSCT staff identified in submitted materials (noted separately under D07).

– Support Driver competence requirements beyond knowledge of route and logistics not specified in submitted materials.

Recommendation

Consider defining minimum staff-to-student ratios — a common approach for cycling tours with student groups is 1:8 to 1:10 as a starting point, adjusted for terrain and age group. Developing a Ride Leader role specification that includes cycling guide qualifications (e.g. British Cycling leadership awards or equivalent), language requirements, and background screening requirements would materially strengthen this dimension. A pre-season staff briefing or induction checklist would formalise the current sign-off approach into a documented training record.

D06 Medical & Welfare

ISO 31031:2022 §A.4, §8.5

45% Foundational

MATURITY BAND

Foundational	Developing	Established	Leading
0–49%	50–69%	70–89%	90%+

CONTEXT SUMMARY

The submitted materials contain some meaningful health and welfare content, particularly around heat management, hypothermia recognition, and the cultural expectation that students self-report welfare concerns. The go/no-go framework also incorporates participant condition as a factor. However, no formal medical management framework is identified: there is no medical information collection process, no medication management protocol, no evidence of how pre-existing conditions are accommodated, and no documented welfare monitoring system beyond informal dinner conversations.

EVIDENCE IDENTIFIED

Evidence from Submitted Materials

DSCT-OPS-001 v1.0, Section 4 (Page 5): 'Heat exhaustion signs: heavy sweating, pale skin, nausea, weakness. Shade, cool water, oral fluids. Stop riding immediately. Heat stroke: confusion, no sweating, hot red skin. Medical emergency. Van called, cold water applied, emergency services if not improving.' — Clinical recognition and response guidance for heat-related illness documented.

DSCT-OPS-001 v1.0, Section 5 (Page 6): 'Severe allergic reaction (use EpiPen if prescribed, call emergency services immediately regardless).' — Allergy and EpiPen management referenced in emergency protocols.

DSCT-OPS-001 v1.0, Section 7 (Page 7): 'The culture on a DSCT tour is one where saying I'm not OK is easy and normal. Ride Leader models this. School trip leader models this.' — Welfare culture statement present; psychological safety explicitly addressed.

DSCT-OPS-001 v1.0, Section 2 (Page 3): 'Ride Leader checks in with each student informally over dinner — not a formal welfare audit, just conversation. Notes anyone who seems off.' — Daily welfare monitoring described, informal in nature.

DSCT-OPS-001 v1.0, Section 1 (Page 3): 'Students — One expectation: they self-report if something's wrong. Physically or mentally. No toughing it out.' — Self-reporting expectation documented.

DSCT-OPS-001 v1.0, Section 5 (Page 6): 'FIRST AID PROTOCOLS — Full first aid procedures to be added by the certified Ride Leader once appointed.' — Explicitly identifies first aid protocols as absent from v1.0.

GAPS IDENTIFIED

– No medical information collection form or pre-tour health disclosure process identified in submitted materials.

– No medication management protocol (storage, administration, recording) identified in submitted materials.

– No process for accommodating students with pre-existing medical conditions identified in submitted materials.

– No documented first aid kit contents list or minimum equipment standard for the support van identified in submitted materials.

– First aid protocols explicitly flagged as absent: 'Full first aid procedures to be added by the certified Ride Leader once appointed' (Section 5, Page 6).

– No mental health or emotional welfare escalation pathway beyond informal dinner check-ins identified in submitted materials.

– No documented process for managing fitness-to-ride decisions for students with ongoing conditions identified in submitted materials.

Recommendation

Consider developing a medical information collection form as a priority — this would typically request details of pre-existing conditions, medications, allergies, dietary requirements, and GP contact details, collected 4–6 weeks before departure. First aid kit minimum standards (contents and inspection schedule) are commonly documented alongside the kit itself. A medication management protocol covering storage, consent for administration, and recording would address a significant gap. The EpiPen reference in Section 5 suggests awareness of anaphylaxis risk — a standalone allergy protocol would be a logical development.

D07 Safeguarding

ISO 31031:2022 §7.2, Annex A.4

28% Foundational

MATURITY BAND

Foundational	Developing	Established	Leading
0–49%	50–69%	70–89%	90%+

CONTEXT SUMMARY

Safeguarding is the most explicitly acknowledged gap in the submitted materials. Section 8 (Gaps Table) identifies 'Formal child protection policy aligned with schools' own — Legal review before first school group travels' as a known gap. Beyond this acknowledgement, the document contains the non-negotiable that 'no student alone in a foreign place' and the social media policy (Section 6), both of which reflect safeguarding awareness.

EVIDENCE IDENTIFIED

Evidence from Submitted Materials

DSCT-OPS-001 v1.0, Section 8 (Page 7, Gaps Table): 'Safeguarding policy — Formal child protection policy aligned with schools' own — Legal review before first school group travels' — Explicitly identifies safeguarding policy as a known gap with a resolution pathway noted.

DSCT-OPS-001 v1.0, Page 2 (Non-Negotiables): '1 No student alone in a foreign place.' — Core safeguarding non-negotiable embedded in operational standards.

DSCT-OPS-001 v1.0, Section 6 (Page 7, Social Media Policy): 'Photos of other students without consent... anything about an incident before Dan Skimin has had a chance to speak to the school.' — Image consent and information management awareness present.

DSCT-OPS-001 v1.0, Section 1 (Page 3): 'School Trip Leader — Responsible for student pastoral welfare, school policies, and communication with parents.' — Pastoral welfare responsibility allocated to school representative, not DSCT.

DSCT-OPS-001 v1.0, Back Card: '1 No student alone in a foreign place' listed as one of the five non-negotiables — reinforced in the quick reference card.

GAPS IDENTIFIED

– No child protection or safeguarding policy document identified in submitted materials — explicitly acknowledged as a gap in Section 8.

– No DBS check, enhanced disclosure, or equivalent international background screening requirement identified in submitted materials for any DSCT staff role.

– No designated safeguarding lead (DSL) or equivalent role identified in submitted materials.

– No safeguarding reporting pathway or escalation procedure for concerns about students identified in submitted materials.

– No code of conduct for DSCT staff regarding professional boundaries with students identified in submitted materials.

– No training requirement for safeguarding awareness for Ride Leaders or Support Drivers identified in submitted materials.

– No process for aligning with individual schools' safeguarding policies identified in submitted materials beyond the general aspiration noted in Section 8.

Recommendation

The safeguarding policy development flagged in Section 8 (legal review before first school group travels) is the correct priority. A common approach is to develop a standalone child protection policy that covers: designated safeguarding responsibilities, reporting procedures, staff code of conduct, and DBS/background screening requirements. This would typically be shared with school trip leaders during the booking process and reviewed annually. Many schools will require sight of this document before confirming a booking — its absence is likely to be a practical barrier to school engagement. Consider engaging with a specialist educational safeguarding advisor rather than a general legal review.

1	7	+22%
FINDINGS ON THIS DIMENSION	GAPS IDENTIFIED	TO DEVELOPING

D08 Incident Response

ISO 31031:2022 §A.2, §8.5

63% Developing

MATURITY BAND

Foundational	Developing	Established	Leading
0–49%	50–69%	70–89%	90%+

CONTEXT SUMMARY

Incident response is the best-developed dimension in the submitted materials, reflecting the founder's evident prioritisation of in-field emergency management. Section 5 provides structured three-step protocols for crashes, missing students, and medical emergencies, with clear decision triggers for emergency services escalation. The five non-negotiables all relate to incident prevention or response.

EVIDENCE IDENTIFIED

Evidence from Submitted Materials

DSCT-OPS-001 v1.0, Section 5 (Page 6): 'The Three-Step First Response — Any Incident: 1. STOP THE RIDE. 2. ACCOUNT FOR EVERYONE. Headcount. 3. CALL FOR HELP EARLY.' — Clear universal incident first response protocol documented.

DSCT-OPS-001 v1.0, Section 5 (Page 6): Missing student protocol with specific timelines: 'Call the student's phone immediately. If no answer within 2 minutes — call Dan Skimin and the school trip leader simultaneously... If no contact within 20 minutes: local emergency services called.' — Time-bound escalation protocol for missing student scenario.

DSCT-OPS-001 v1.0, Section 5 (Page 6): 'When to Call Emergency Services — No Debate Required: Chest pain or difficulty breathing. Unconsciousness or altered mental state. Suspected broken bone... Severe allergic reaction... Any injury to the head, neck, or spine. Any situation where the Ride Leader is uncertain. Uncertainty = call. Always.' — Explicit emergency services trigger list documented.

DSCT-OPS-001 v1.0, Section 5 (Page 6): 'Do not move a student who has hit their head until spinal injury is considered. When in doubt — don't move them. Wait for professional help.' — Spinal injury precaution protocol present.

DSCT-OPS-001 v1.0, Back Card: Emergency contacts structure with roles and local emergency numbers for all 8 tour countries listed — practical field reference tool.

DSCT-OPS-001 v1.0, Section 5 (Page 6): 'Ride suspended for the day if the injury is anything beyond a graze. Everyone goes to the hotel. There is no carrying on after a serious incident.' — Post-incident group management protocol stated.

DSCT-OPS-001 v1.0, Appendix (Page 8, Quick Incident Log): 'Date · Who · What · What we did · What we learned.' — Basic incident recording template present.

GAPS IDENTIFIED

– No formal incident reporting form identified in submitted materials — explicitly acknowledged as 'a proper one is coming' in the Appendix.

– No documented parent/guardian notification protocol for incidents identified in submitted materials (Section 6 implies school mediates, but process not defined).

– No insurance notification or claims process documented in submitted materials.

– First aid protocols explicitly absent: 'Full first aid procedures to be added by the certified Ride Leader once appointed' (Section 5).

– No post-incident debrief or psychological support protocol for students following a serious incident identified in submitted materials.

– No business continuity or tour cancellation protocol identified in submitted materials for scenarios where a tour cannot proceed.

– Local hospital and clinic contact information for each of the 8 tour destinations noted as absent: 'Add local hospital names per tour as we build them out' (Section 5, Page 6).

Recommendation

The incident response foundation in Section 5 is the strongest element of the submitted materials. Consider formalising this into a dedicated Incident Management Procedure document that incorporates the three-step protocol, the escalation timelines, a parent notification cascade, and an insurance notification trigger. The incident log in the Appendix is a good start — a structured form with fields for severity classification, actions taken, and follow-up required would support both operational learning and any insurance or school reporting requirements. Local hospital contacts per tour destination are a practical gap that can be addressed during pre-tour reconnaissance.

D09 Communications

ISO 31031:2022 §8.2

56% Developing

MATURITY BAND

Foundational	Developing	Established	Leading
0–49%	50–69%	70–89%	90%+

CONTEXT SUMMARY

DSCT's communication framework is partially developed. Section 6 provides a clear daily communication loop between Ride Leader, Dan Skimin, and School Trip Leader, with a sensible principle that the school mediates parent communications. The social media policy on Day 1 is a practical and well-framed approach.

EVIDENCE IDENTIFIED

Evidence from Submitted Materials

DSCT-OPS-001 v1.0, Section 6 (Page 7): 'Ride Leader → Dan Skimin: End of every riding day: a quick check-in message... If there's anything more serious — call, don't message.' — Daily end-of-day communication protocol with escalation trigger documented.

DSCT-OPS-001 v1.0, Section 6 (Page 7): 'Ride Leader → School Trip Leader: Same brief at end of each day. School trip leader is the channel to parents — DSCT staff do not contact parents directly during a tour except in genuine emergencies where the school is unreachable.' — Communication hierarchy and parent contact protocol stated.

DSCT-OPS-001 v1.0, Section 6 (Page 7): Social Media Policy — 'Students can post about the tour... What they cannot post in real time: precise location of the group, photos of other students without consent, anything about an incident before Dan Skimin has had a chance to speak to the school.' — Digital communication policy with location security and consent provisions documented.

DSCT-OPS-001 v1.0, Section 2 (Page 3): 'Tomorrow's plan confirmed. Any route changes communicated to school trip leader and support driver.' — Route change communication protocol embedded in daily rhythm.

DSCT-OPS-001 v1.0, Section 6 (Page 7): 'TO BUILD — A one-page communication plan template for each school partner — who to call, when, and what to say.' — Explicitly acknowledges communication plan as absent from v1.0.

DSCT-OPS-001 v1.0, Section 1 (Page 3): 'Support Driver — Stays in phone contact with the Ride Leader throughout the day.' — Intra-team communication standard documented.

GAPS IDENTIFIED

– No formal communication plan template identified in submitted materials — explicitly flagged as 'TO BUILD' in Section 6.

– No documented backup communication protocol for scenarios where primary phone contact fails identified in submitted materials.

– No pre-tour communication schedule with schools (booking, pre-departure, during tour, post-tour) identified in submitted materials.

– No crisis communication protocol for managing media, parent groups, or social media in the event of a serious incident identified in submitted materials.

– No specification of communication equipment or devices required for Ride Leaders and Support Drivers identified in submitted materials.

– No process for communicating tour changes or cancellations to schools before departure identified in submitted materials.

Recommendation

The communication hierarchy in Section 6 is a strong foundation. Consider formalising this into a communication plan template that is completed for each school partner at booking — covering key contacts, communication frequency, escalation triggers, and emergency notification timelines. A common approach is to distinguish between routine communications (daily check-in format), operational communications (route changes, welfare concerns), and emergency communications (incident notification cascade). Specifying backup communication methods (e.g. satellite phone or messaging app) for remote tour stages would address a practical safety gap.

D10 Post-Trip Review

ISO 31031:2022 §7.6, §7.7, §A.3, §8.6

38% Foundational

MATURITY BAND

Foundational	Developing	Established	Leading
0–49%	50–69%	70–89%	90%+

CONTEXT SUMMARY

Post-trip review is the least developed dimension in the submitted materials. The document's 'living document' philosophy is genuinely oriented toward continuous improvement — this is commendable — but no formal post-trip review process, participant feedback mechanism, or structured learning capture system is identified. The Quick Incident Log in the Appendix provides a rudimentary learning record, and the version notes section invites ongoing contributions.

EVIDENCE IDENTIFIED

Evidence from Submitted Materials

DSCT-OPS-001 v1.0, Page 2 (Prefatory Note): 'Version 1.0 means we wrote down what we know now. Version 1.1 will have the things we learn on the first few tours. Version 2.0 will be better than both.' — Explicit commitment to iterative improvement based on operational learning.

DSCT-OPS-001 v1.0, Appendix (Page 8, Quick Incident Log): 'Date · Tour · What Happened · Response · Learning' — Basic incident-to-learning loop documented in template form.

DSCT-OPS-001 v1.0, Appendix (Page 8, Version Notes): 'When you find something that needs changing in this document, write it here. Date it. Sign it. That's how we build v1.1 together.' — Continuous improvement mechanism embedded in document structure.

DSCT-OPS-001 v1.0, Section 2 (Page 3): 'Ride Leader calls or messages Dan Skimin if anything worth reporting happened today. Good or bad.' — Daily reporting to founder implied as learning input, informal in nature.

DSCT-OPS-001 v1.0, Section 8 (Page 7): The Gaps Table itself — 'Gap · What's Needed · How We'll Fill It' — functions as a self-assessment and improvement backlog, demonstrating structured self-awareness.

GAPS IDENTIFIED

– No formal post-trip review or debrief process identified in submitted materials for Ride Leaders or DSCT operations staff.

– No participant (student) feedback collection mechanism identified in submitted materials.

– No school satisfaction survey or partner feedback process identified in submitted materials.

– No documented review meeting structure or frequency for operational learning identified in submitted materials.

– No process for systematically translating tour learnings into policy or procedure updates identified in submitted materials beyond the open-ended version notes invitation.

– No annual review trigger or policy renewal schedule identified in submitted materials.

– No performance metrics or key performance indicators for tour safety or quality identified in submitted materials.

Recommendation

Consider developing a simple post-trip review structure — a common approach is a two-page debrief template completed by the Ride Leader within 48 hours of tour completion, covering safety incidents, welfare observations, supplier performance, and suggested improvements. A short student feedback survey (5–7 questions) and a school trip leader debrief call would close the feedback loop. The Gaps Table in Section 8 is an excellent model for the improvement backlog — formalising this into a quarterly review meeting (Ride Leader + Dan Skimin) with documented outputs would create the structured learning cycle that v1.0 aspires to but does not yet specify.

1	7	+12%
FINDINGS ON THIS DIMENSION	GAPS IDENTIFIED	TO DEVELOPING

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Priority Action Plan

This page lists all identified gaps grouped by advisory timeline. Timelines are assigned based on urgency: 60 days (critical), 90 days (high priority), 120 days (improvement).

> These actions are preparation steps, not compliance requirements. They indicate areas where documentation development would strengthen the organisation's governance framework and readiness for school group deployment.

PRIORITY ACTION PLAN

#	Dim	Gap Description	Timeline
1	D07 Safeguarding	No child protection or safeguarding policy identified in submitted materials. Develop a standalone safeguarding policy covering designated safeguarding responsibilities, staff code of conduct, reporting procedures for concerns about students, and DBS/background screening requirements for all staff working with minors. Engage a specialist educational safeguarding advisor to review before first school group travels. This document should be shared proactively with school partners during the booking process.	60d
2	D03 Partner Vetting	No supplier or partner vetting framework identified in submitted materials for accommodation providers, bike rental partners, or local operators. Develop a supplier approval checklist covering minimum insurance requirements, accommodation security standards (student room security, emergency procedures), bike maintenance and safety standards for rental partners, and an annual review process. Prioritise accommodation and bike rental as critical supplier categories.	60d
3	D02 Risk Assessment	No formal pre-trip risk assessment process or risk register identified in submitted materials. Develop a pre-trip risk assessment template covering destination risk (FCDO/equivalent travel advisory, political stability, health risks), route-specific hazards, and participant profile considerations. Complete a documented risk assessment for each of the 8 tour destinations before first departure. Formalise the existing go/no-go table as part of a broader risk assessment toolkit.	60d
4	D10 Post-Trip Review	No post-trip review process, participant feedback mechanism, or school debrief structure identified in submitted materials. Develop a Ride Leader post-trip debrief template (to be completed within 48 hours of tour completion), a short student feedback survey, and a school trip leader debrief call format. Establish a quarterly review meeting between Ride Leader and Dan Skimin to translate learnings into documented policy updates. Define a minimum annual review cycle for the Operations and Safety Manual.	60d
5	D06 Medical & Welfare	No medical information collection form, medication management protocol, or first aid kit minimum standards identified in submitted materials. Develop a participant medical disclosure form to be collected 4–6 weeks before departure, covering pre-existing conditions, medications, allergies, dietary requirements, and GP contact details. Document first aid kit minimum contents and inspection schedule for the support van. Develop a medication management protocol covering storage, consent for administration, and recording. Complete the first aid protocols section once Ride Leader is appointed.	60d
6	D04 Pre-Departure Documentation	No pre-departure documentation package identified in submitted materials for students, parents, or school trip leaders. Develop a school-facing pre-departure pack (shared 6–8 weeks before departure) and a student-facing pack (shared 2 weeks before). Include participant welcome letter, kit list, medical disclosure form, emergency contact collection, destination overview, and cultural guidance notes. Formalise the Day 1 morning briefing script once first tours have been completed.	90d
7	D01 Governance & Policy	No formal travel risk management policy statement identified in submitted materials distinct from the operational manual. Develop a brief (1–2 page) governing policy statement articulating DSCT's risk management scope, objectives, risk appetite, and alignment to relevant standards. Add a documented annual review trigger and a named deputy for governance continuity. Establish a document control register to track policy versions and review history.	90d

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Priority Action Plan (continued)

8	**D05**	Staffing & Ratios	No staff-to-student ratios, Ride Leader recruitment criteria beyond First Aid certification, or staff training programme identified in submitted materials. Define minimum staff-to-student ratios for cycling tours with student groups. Develop a Ride Leader role specification including cycling guide qualifications, language requirements, and background screening. Create a pre-season staff induction checklist to formalise the existing sign-off process into a documented training record. Specify Support Driver competence requirements.	90d
9	**D09**	Communications	No formal communication plan template or backup communication protocol identified in submitted materials. Develop a per-school communication plan template covering key contacts, communication frequency, escalation triggers, and emergency notification timelines. Specify backup communication methods for remote tour stages. Develop a crisis communication protocol for serious incident scenarios covering parent groups, school leadership, and media. Define pre-tour communication schedule milestones from booking to departure.	90d
10	**D08**	Incident Response	No formal incident reporting form, parent notification cascade, or post-incident psychological support protocol identified in submitted materials. Local hospital contacts absent for all 8 tour destinations. Develop a structured incident reporting form with severity classification and follow-up fields. Document a parent notification cascade procedure and an insurance notification trigger process. Research and document local hospital and clinic contacts for each tour destination during pre-tour reconnaissance. Develop a brief post-incident student support protocol.	120d

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Next Steps & Reassessment

The priority action plan in this document is organised by advisory timeline. The steps below describe how to work through the findings, and how ETI360 closes the loop on reassessment.

WHAT HAPPENS NEXT

1 Review with governance

Walk the priority action plan with your governance team and risk lead. Confirm ownership for each 60-day item.

2 Close critical gaps

Develop or update documentation for 60-day (critical) items first. These items constrain school deployment readiness.

3 Address high-priority

Work through 90-day and 120-day items once critical documentation is in place and under governance review.

4 Reassess

Schedule a follow-up ETI360 assessment once material documentation changes are implemented to validate progress.

MATURITY DISTRIBUTION ACROSS 10 DIMENSIONS

FOUNDATIONAL	DEVELOPING	ESTABLISHED	LEADING
6	4	0	0
0–49%	50–69%	70–89%	90%+

DOCUMENTS ASSESSED

DSCT_Operations_Safety_Manual_v1.0.pdf

ENGAGEMENT CONTACT

ETI360 can support documentation development and governance framework design between this assessment and the reassessment. Reach out to your assigned analyst to scope the engagement.